

District Report

Gorkha

29 December 2017 – 4 January 2018

Activity Summary

Activity	Contact Person	Reference Document
HRRP Gorkha team visited DL-PIU, DDC/EHRP, CARE, Caritas & OXFAM for the participation in exposure visit conducted at Aarughat Rural Municipality. - HRRP Gorkha district team consulted the status of files recommended to DDC for recommendation for 2nd tranche with DL-PIU and DDC/EHRP. - HRRP Gorkha team visited CARE Nepal and discussed about the UCPVA tool facilitation to the partners for vulnerability assessment of HHs and planned UCPVA tool on 12 January 2018 for the uniformity in vulnerability assessment. HRRP also requested to participate in the exposure visit at Aarughat Rural Municipality to observe the working modalities of focal persons deployed in Aarughat Rural Municipality through partner and looked for possible deployment of focal person in CARE working areas HRRP district team also visited to Caritas office and discussed about the agenda of exposure visit & possible deployment of focal person in Gorkha Municipality through Caritas. Caritas shared the challenges of deployment of focal person in Gorkha municipality in the development of terms of reference of focal person. Caritas has some reservation to be clarified on ToR of focal person in the municipality	dc.gorkha@hrrpnepal.org; nragorkha@gmail.com	
HRRP Gorkha team organized an exposure visit at Aarughat Rural Municipality led by Mr. Atit Shrestha – Technical Coordinator – HRRP, and discussed the agenda of focal persons working modality, reporting mechanism, reconstruction update from ward level and ward level coordination meeting in between technical persons of DL-PIU, technical persons of partners and local representatives. The details of the exposure visit and coordination meeting at Aarughat Rural Municipality has been mentioned in field visit section below.	dc.gorkha@hrrpnepal.org techncord.gorkha@hrrpnepal.org	Click Here
On 3rd January 2018, HRRP Gorkha District Coordinator, Mr. Chandra Gurung, accompanied with Mr. Shivil Poudyal – Chief of NRA, Gorkha, participated in the opening of 7 days short mason training organized by NRA, Gorkha at Swara – 3, Sulikot Rural Municipality. The	dc.gorkha@hrrpnepal.org nragorkha@gmail.com	Click Here

Activity Summary

detail of the training has been mentioned in the field visit report section below.		
HRRP/NRA Gorkha, including representative from DL-PIU, participated a 'Public Hearing Program' organized by Samata Foundation on 4th January 2018 at Hotel Miracle, Gorkha. NRA/HRRP responded the queries raised by the local representatives, community people of Bhimsen Rural Municipality & Sahid Lakhani Thapa Rural Municipality on the diverse issues on reconstruction related issues. NRA/HRRP responded each question with precision and clarity. Questions and queries raised during the public hearing program include in the question answers section below. Also, queries responded by NRA/DL-PIU & HRRP in the question collected section below. HRRP Gorkha also updated the reconstruction status, beneficiaries receiving 2nd and 3rd tranche as of now, 3rd place in reconstruction out of 14 districts, overall its coordination support to bridge gaps in reconstruction efforts in the district.	dc.gorkha@hrrpnepal.org techcord.gorkha@hrrpnepal.org nragorkha@gmail.com	
HRRP district team met with OXFAM and discussed on the issues of formally deploying focal point at Sahid Lakhani Thapa Rural Municipality; D2D status, and top -up support (up to 50 thousand) to vulnerable HHs, support & monitoring mechanisms etc. HRRP shared the plan of UCPVA tool orientation to identify vulnerable HHs in coordination with CARE Nepal for the uniformity of vulnerable assessments.	dc.gorkha@hrrpnepal.org , techcord.gorkha@hrrpnepal.org ,	
HRRP focal person with support from Aarughat Rural Municipality and HRRP district team Gorkha conducted ward level coordination meeting at Aaruphokhari – 7 & 8 of Aarughat Rural Municipality. In the coordination meeting, ward chairpersons Mr. Rana Bahadur Baram & Murari Khanal and DL-PIU engineers and other local stakeholders were participated. The ward level coordination meeting was focused on the present of status of reconstruction issues, non-compliance issues and technical assistance by using correction manual to meet the standard of reconstruction criteria.	dc.gorkha@hrrpnepal.org techcord.gorkha@hrrpnepal.org	

Upcoming Events & Meetings

Event / Meeting	Date, Time, and Location	Contact Person
Closing of Mason Training at Sulikot organized by NRA	9 th January 2018	Atit Shrestha/Santoshi Lamichane
UCPVA Tool Orientation	12 January 2018	Chandra Gurung

News & Updates

- Mr. Hari Ram Parajuli, Private Housing Reconstruction Coordinator / Grievance Coordinator from NRA central visited Gorkha district and interacted with local stakeholders, community people and local representatives on the issues of reconstruction progress, Buddhi Gandaki affected areas challenges in reconstruction, and current scenario of Gorkha district.
- District Coordination Committee, Gorkha has decided to extend three months additional deadline of Mid-January (Paush Masanta) to receive 2nd tranche for the reconstruction of houses. This news has published as headline in local magazines in Gorkha district on Friday. A news related to extend deadline published in 'Gorkha Samachar Daily' has been attached below.



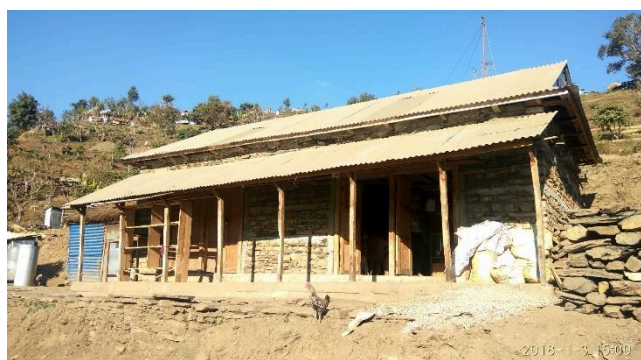
Field Visit Reports

Date	Location	Participants
3 rd January 2017	Swara – 3, Sulikot Rural Municipality	- Mr. Shiv Lal Poudyal - NRA - Mr. Chandra Gurung - HRRP
Objective(s)	Opening of 7 Days Mason Training (Short Training) organized by NRA to support to fulfill the gaps of skilled mason in Sulikot Rural Municipality	

Summary	Opening of mason training (7 days) organized by NRA, Gorkha at Swara – 3, Sulikot Rural Municipality (3rd January 2018) ➤ NRA Gorkha kicked off 7 days mason training at Swara – 3, Sulikot Rural Municipality on 3rd January 2018. 30 participants representing from different areas of Swara are participating in the mason training. The training lasts for seven days. In the opening of the mason training, Mr. Santa Bahadur Tamang – Chairperson of Swara – 3, Sulikot Rural Municipality, chaired the program. The chief guests in the opening of the mason training were Mr. Bishnu Bhatta – Chairperson of Sulikot Rural Municipality, Mr. Amar Tamu – Ex CA member, Mr. Nar Bahadur Gurung, Deputy Chair of National Indigenous Association, Mr. Sailesh Dungana – Executive Officer of Sulikot Rural Municipality, Mr. Shival Poudyal – Chief of NRA, Gorkha, and Mr. Chandra Gurung – District Coordinator, HRRP, Gorkha. ➤ In the opening of the mason training, Mr. Shival Poudyal – Chief of NRA, Gorkha explained the objective of the mason training organized at Swara. Mr. Poudyal summarized the objective of the mason training (7 days) in the following points. ➤ To fulfill the gaps in mason in reconstruction process in the community ➤ The mason training was targeted to skilled labors, who are working in the same field now ➤ To collect suggestion and feedbacks in building houses at the end of the moment which will be incorporated in the planning of mason training in future ➤ To support to receive the tranche by meeting the criteria of housing codes ➤ To help in skill development and support livelihood opportunity ➤ To cash the capacity of skilled resources in housing and other reconstruction activities. ➤ To orient about retrofitting and repair of already built houses to the trainees to meet the compliance In the event, Mr. Bhatta also expressed best wishes to succeed the mason training, and which will be the best resources to cash in the rural municipality level reconstruction activities. He urged that this type of training was seriously needed at Swara, which is back warded area of Sulikot Rural Municipality. He believed that this training would fulfill the gaps in the areas of skilled mason in this part of the community. And he committed to supporting in reconstruction process as much as possible as a local representative. The opening session was closed by Mr. Tamang and thanked NRA, Gorkha for brining this type of training there. In the meantime, Mr. Shival Poudyal – Chief of NRA, Gorkha answered the queries raised by community people. Queries like - what about the deadline of mid-January to receive the 2nd tranche? - if there are only two elder people above 70 years by age and they can't build their houses by themselves (like other vulnerable many HHs involving this sort of situation), is there any plan to address this issue by government of Nepal and National Reconstruction Authority? NRA/HRRP observed the houses reconstructed and houses which are under reconstruction upon receiving the government grants. Some of the houses are already completed and received all the tranche from government and some are recommended for 2nd tranche.

Challenges / Issues Identified	Action Required	Responsible	Timeframe
Lack of materials available in the community to reconstruct houses and there are more chances of black market in materials supply which would cost higher	Local government should facilitate to get materials easily and reasonable cost with market and vendors. Vendors also need to understand the spirit of reconstruction activities in the community and supply the materials cost effectively	Local Government, NRA, Local Representatives	Jan – Feb - 2018
Vulnerable HHs, including elderly at risk, single women at risk are unable to build their houses if there is no any additional support	Data assessment should be conducted in the leadership of local representative and should recommend addressing the issues to the possible extent	Local Bodies, POs & NRA	Jan – Feb - 2018

Photos



Stone in mud, flexible roof with wood frame, concrete band, Swara – ३, Sulikot



Mr. Shival Poudyal - Chief of NRA, Gorkha speaking on the objective of 7 days mason training in the opening session of the training organized by NRA, Gorkha

Date	Location	Participants
3 rd January 2018	Aarughat Rural Municipality	- Atit Shrestha - Mr. Khagendra Awasthi - (MES DUDBC), - Mr. Sanjaya Nayak (Engineer, DLPIU), - Mr. Bibek Shrestha (Shelter Coordinator, Care), - Mr. Durga Lama and Caritas team, - Mr. Abhishek Shrestha (Senior Project Engineer, CRS), - Sudeep Karmacharya (Admin Assistant, EHRP) - Shelter officer (Goreto, Partner OXFAM)
Objective(s)	Field Visit to Aarughat Rural Municipality (Ward Level coordination meeting for ward no 9 & 10)	
Summary	Ward Level Coordination meeting for ward no 9 & 10 and exposure visit for work related to Focal person	

- Mr. Khagendra Awasthi (MES DUDBC), Mr. Atit Shrestha (District Technical Coordinator, HRRP Gorkha), Mr. Sanjaya Nayak (Engineer, DLPIU), Mr. Bibek Shrestha (Shelter Coordinator, Care), Mr. Durga Lama and Caritas team, Mr. Abhishek Shrestha (Senior Project Engineer, CRS), Sudeep Karmacharya (Admin Assistant, EHRP) and Shelter officer (Goreto, Partner OXFAM) jointly visited Aarughat rural municipality for ward level coordination meeting of ward no 9 and 10 organized by Sunil Pokhrel (Focal Person of Aarughat R.M) and to observe the working environment and performance of focal person in Aarughat Rural Municipality.
- The meeting was chaired by the ward chairman of ward no 9 Mr. Dil Bahadur Roka with rural municipality chairperson Mr. Purna Dahal as the special guest. After primary introduction by all participants, the discussion was focused in mainly 2 points i.e. performance of focal person in Aarughat R.M and present status of reconstruction in both ward no 9 and 10 and challenges faced.
- The general participants asked various question especially focusing on the reconstruction and tranche related updates to the representative of DUDBC and EHRP and the representatives answered them as far as possible.
- Participants seeked clarification regarding delays in solving the issues of grievances as they are yet unclear whether they will be beneficiaries even if they have filled up grievance form. The representatives of EHRP clarified that they are in process of registering grievances in DCC but some parts of Gorkha are yet to send their list of grievances. Once all the grievances from all the parts of Gorkha are collected they will be sent to the central office for further processing.
- Participants also raised questions regarding Budhigandaki affected area. The Rural municipality chairperson gave the details of the visit of Mr. Hari Ram Parajuli (Central NRA) and the answers given by him regarding Budhigandaki and affected area to answer the question regarding Budhigandaki of participants.
- Mr. Purna Dahal raised the question of shortage of tablets with the field engineers as they only have 1 tablets among them which is also hampering the progress. They are unable to cover, prepare and process more files even if the construction has been completed and the beneficiaries are eligible for the tranches. Mr. Khagendra Awasthi shared that central NRA has procured additional tablets and software installation and update are ongoing and will be sent to the field as soon as possible
- Participants raised question regarding delay in second and third tranche release as some beneficiaries are yet to receive tranches for more than 3 months. They complained about lack of information about status of tranche files and files being lost. The representatives of both DUDBC and EHRP answered that there have been some delays previously due to elections and vote counting. But now they have processed most of the files accumulated during that time. Similarly, they shared that DCC is facing some problem with proper storage and recording of files coming from all over Gorkha and are trying to solve the issue.
- Similarly, the participant also made an agreement to keep record of all the tranche files sent to district in rural municipality and focal person will be responsible for keeping record.
- Mr. Purna Dahal, chairperson of Aarughat R.M shared the contribution of focal person and help desk in the reconstruction of R.M. He shared that the focal person was responsible for sharing information to the beneficiaries regarding mainly 2 points i.e. technical support to beneficiaries regarding construction and standards to be met to be eligible for tranches and share information regarding tranche files and keep record of all tranche files. In his own word Mr. Purna

	Dahal shared that “he has shifted his load on the shoulders of Sunil regarding reconstruction and he focuses on other activities”. • Mr. Durga Lama shared on behalf of participants from different agencies. He shared that they are all pleased with the progress made by Aarughat R.M and with the vision of its leadership regarding reconstruction. He also shared that Caritas is looking at establishing a help desk and focal person in Gorkha municipality and was there to observe the work being done through focal person in Aarughat. They will be keeping in touch and will seek information before making a formal decision. • Mr. Dil Bahadur Roka, ward chairperson made the closing remarks and thanked all the participants for active participation. He also shared that these kinds of coordination meeting were fruitful in clarifying issues that rise in the ward level. He also shared that these kinds of meeting will be fruitful soon.
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Challenges / Issues Identified	Action Required	Responsible	Timeframe
Information regarding grievances to the beneficiaries	DCC and district based stakeholders need to register and publish the list of beneficiaries as soon as possible and share the information to the rural municipality		
Coordination among POs, municipality and ward officials and DLPIU engineers	Timely coordination meeting among the stakeholders at ward level		

Photos



Mr. Purna Dahal, chairperson of Aarughat Rural Municipality sharing the updates of reconstruction in the rural municipality. He also shared about the visit of Mr. Hari Ram Parajuli to the participants.



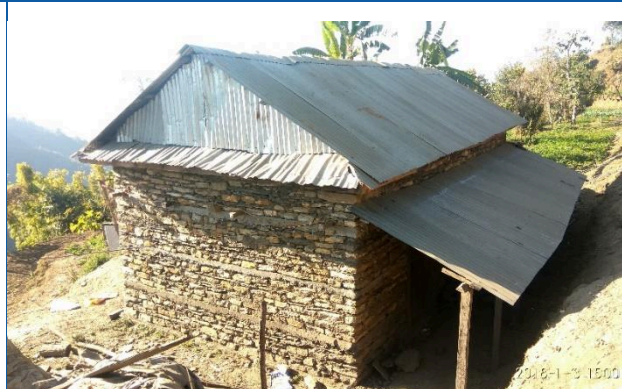
Mr. Sudeep Karmacharya, Admin assistant EHRP, giving answers to questions asked by participants.

Housing Typology Report



Stone in mud, flexible roof with wood frame, concrete band, Swara – 3, Sulikot

Photo



Stone in Mud, Flexible roof with wood frame, concrete band – Swara – 3, Sulikot

Photo



A House under construction (stone, mud, cement and wood) recommended for 2nd tranche at Swara - 3, Sulikot



House (stone with mud, cement band and wood with light roof) built with support from government grant and already received for all tranche at Swara – 3, Sulikot RM.

Questions Collected

Question	Who Asked the Question?	Response Provided (By Whom)
What will be the provision or action will be taken for those who are landless, displaced?	Participants	If beneficiaries do not have land, and they are inhabiting in government land, public land, forest areas; and if they are listed in beneficiaries list, government will provide 2 lakhs to buy land to build their house by investigating the real scenario. In this case, government doesn't provide them cash, instead, beneficiaries and land owner should have made MoU or so, and within 30 days, beneficiary should start reconstructing the houses (NRA)
What is the criteria of building houses in the Budhi Gandani affected areas? And confusion regarding building houses in these	Ward Chairperson	If beneficiaries want to build houses in Budhi Gandagi affected areas, they can build temporary houses, which must also meet the minimum standard of building compliance

Questions Collected

areas whether they build temporary houses?		(earthquake resilient) set forth by DL-PIU (NRA)
What will be the provision for those HHs who are socio-economically vulnerable (elderly people above 70 years of age, extremely poor families, and single women & men)?	Ward Chairperson	Date collection and vulnerability assessment will be conducted to identify such HHs and will make necessary recommendation to address these issues (NRA)
Confusing vibration are penetrated in the community people due to the deadline set forth for mid-January and what is that?	Participants	If beneficiaries are willing to reconstruct their houses, but due to different obstacles such as lack of skilled masons, supply of materials etc. should start building their houses and NRA will help them to receive 2 nd tranche; but if beneficiaries are living outside the village (For instance, Kathmandu, Narayanghat) they will not be eligible to receive the 2 nd tranche and NRA will not facilitate anymore for such cases. (NRA)
A single room house is for whom? Does this type of house meet the compliance and accommodate a nuclear family?	Participants	Single room house is targeted for only single women and not for joint family. (NRA)
Does beneficiary still get to register grievance or not?	Participants	The time line of collecting grievance is already completed so beneficiaries can't register grievance now; and if grievance is already registered, those will be addressed. (NRA)
Can beneficiary build their houses in neighboring district?	Participants	If beneficiaries want to build their houses in neighboring district, they can build houses only in bordering district and local bodies. (NRA)
What is flexible loan (subsidized) scheme? Can everyone get this type of loan from government?	Participants/beneficiaries	If beneficiaries want to take flexible (subsidized) loan (low interest rate loan), they can get up to 15 lakhs on condition that they should kept their property documents as stock exchange; and if they want to take loan in collective responsibility (samuhik jamani), they can get up to 3 lakhs; but bank is not able to provide loan because of not making agreement with private bank. (NRA)
Houses which are already built/reconstructed, and those houses are getting difficulty in	Ward Member	If already reconstructed houses are out of compliance and / or do not meet the criteria of building codes, those houses will be inspected and

Questions Collected

meeting the compliance to by recommended by engineers?		monitored by engineers and make necessary suggestions for retrofitting and repair for compliance; and if the houses are gXg, these types of houses are also being inspected and monitored by engineers; and the houses are constructed made of wood, an inspection and correction manual was already released and need to consult with engineers. (DL-PIU/NRA)
What will be the provision taken for those who are not enrolled in the beneficiary list yet?	Participants/beneficiaries	There seemed communication gap in the community people; and there was already survey was completed and to include all the beneficiaries from other earthquake affected district as well, all beneficiaries will be enrolled simultaneously. (NRA)

Challenges and Way Forward

Challenge	Way Forward
Lack of materials available in the community to reconstruct houses and there are more chances of black market in materials supply which would cost higher	Local government should facilitate to get materials easily and reasonable cost with market and vendors. Vendors also need to understand the spirit of reconstruction activities in the community and supply the materials cost effectively
Vulnerable HHs, including elderly at risk, single women at risk are unable to build their houses if there is no any additional support	Data assessment should be conducted in the leadership of local representative and should recommend addressing the issues to the possible extent
Information regarding grievances to the beneficiaries	DCC and district based stakeholders need to register and publish the list of beneficiaries as soon as possible and share the information to the rural municipality
Coordination among POs, municipality and ward officials and DLPIU engineers	Timely coordination meeting among the stakeholders at ward level